

Article 26 Inquiry — Step-by-Step Guide

Substance: HVO (Renewable hydrocarbons, diesel type fraction) **EC Number:** 700-571-2 | **CAS Number:** 928771-01-1
Prepared: 2026-04-20 **Company:** Portland Fuel Ltd

What is an Article 26 Inquiry?

Under UK REACH, any company intending to register a substance must first submit an **Article 26 Inquiry** to HSE before submitting the full registration dossier. This is a mandatory legal step — you cannot skip straight to registration.

Its purpose is twofold:

1. HSE checks whether the substance is already registered under UK REACH
2. Your contact details are shared with the existing registrant group, allowing you to make contact and negotiate joining the consortium

For HVO, registration number **UK-01-9638319484-0-0004** already exists. This means the Article 26 Inquiry will identify the Lead Registrant of that existing registration, reveal their contact details to you, and share your contact details with them. This is how Portland Fuel initiates contact with the existing HVO consortium to negotiate joining as a member registrant.

Important: There is no pre-registration system under UK REACH. Article 26 is the only route. Pre-registrations submitted to ECHA under EU REACH are not valid in Great Britain.

What You Will Receive

After a successful inquiry, HSE will:

- Issue an **inquiry number** (keep this for your records)
- Reveal the **identity of the Lead Registrant** through the portal
- Share **your contact details** with all existing registrants for that substance
- Confirm whether you can **defer full data submission** by joining the existing joint registration

This gives Portland Fuel everything needed to approach the consortium and begin negotiating a Letter of Access (LoA) — which is Step 2 of the Action Plan.

Processing time: Up to 10–15 working days (approximately 2 weeks).

Prerequisites

Before you can submit, you need two things in place:

A. Government Gateway Account

The portal uses Government Gateway authentication (not [GOV.UK](#) One Login).

- If your organisation does not already have a Government Gateway account, you can create one at first access to the portal
- Link it to Portland Fuel as the legal entity during account setup
- **Keep this account active:** Log in at least once every three years or it will deactivate, potentially losing submission history

B. IUCLID 6 Cloud Account

The inquiry dossier must be prepared in IUCLID 6 (the EU/UK standard chemical dossier software) and submitted as a .i6z file. The cloud version is free.

- **IUCLID 6 Cloud:** [IUCLID 6 Cloud Login \(ECHA\)](#)
- Sign up with your work email address
- Your Legal Entity in IUCLID must match the company details you use in the Comply with UK REACH portal

If you have previously worked on IUCLID for the Urea project, you can use the same account — Legal Entities and dossiers are stored separately.

Substance Information to Have Ready

Use these pre-verified identifiers when completing the IUCLID inquiry dossier:

Field	Value
Substance name	Renewable hydrocarbons (diesel type fraction)
Common trade name	HVO (Hydrotreated Vegetable Oil) / Paraffinic Diesel
EC Number	700-571-2
CAS Number	928771-01-1
Molecular formula	C10-20 H22-42
Substance type	UVCB (Unknown or Variable composition, Complex reaction products or Biological materials)
Existing UK REACH registration	UK-01-9638319484-0-0004
Intended tonnage band	10–100 tonnes/year

Step-by-Step Submission Guide

Step 1 — Prepare the Inquiry Dossier in IUCLID 6

The inquiry dossier is a simplified IUCLID file. You do **not** need to complete a full chemical safety assessment at this stage — only substance identity sections are required.

Log in to IUCLID 6 Cloud and complete the following sections:

Section 1.1 — Legal Entity

Enter Portland Fuel's registered company details:

- Company name
- Registered address
- Contact person
- Email address

Critical (GB REACH requirement): Contact details entered in Section 1.1 of the dossier itself are what HSE uses for the contact-sharing process. Do not rely on the portal account details alone — they must be in the dossier file too.

Reference Substance

Create or locate the reference substance using the identifiers in the table above:

- EC Number: 700-571-2
- CAS Number: 928771-01-1
- Substance name: Renewable hydrocarbons (diesel type fraction)
- IUPAC name (if available from an SDS)
- Molecular structure / formula

Section 1.2 — Substance Composition

HVO is a **UVCB substance** — this requires specific treatment compared to a mono-constituent substance:

- Define the substance by its constituent hydrocarbon range (C15-C18 isoalkanes predominate)
- Aromatics: typically <1.0% by weight
- Note zero sulphur content and zero FAME content
- Refer to Greenergy or Phillips 66 SDS for composition data

UVCB substances are not defined by a single molecular structure. Describe the process origin and key compositional boundaries instead.

Section 1.4 — Analytical Information

Provide information establishing substance identity. For an inquiry dossier, this is typically descriptive rather than requiring new test data:

- Reference the existing supplier SDS (Phillips 66 February 2024 version is most current)
- Chromatographic data showing hydrocarbon profile (available from SDS)
- Spectral methods used for identification

Export the Dossier

Once sections 1.1, Reference Substance, and 1.2 are complete:

1. Click **Create Dossier** in IUCLID 6
2. Use the **advanced option** and select "include legal entity" — this is required for UK REACH submissions and is not the default behaviour
3. Select dossier type: **Inquiry**
4. Export as .i6z file and save to your computer

Step 2 — Submit via the Comply with UK REACH Portal

Portal: [Comply with UK REACH — Comply with chemical regulations](#)

1. Log in using your **Government Gateway** credentials
2. On first use, complete the **Defra account setup** (legal entity registration for Portland Fuel)
3. Navigate to **New Submission** or **Start a Registration**
4. When prompted, upload your `.i6z` inquiry dossier file
5. Confirm the submission details and submit
6. **Note your submission reference number** — keep this safe

If the portal shows an error or the "Create Dossier" button was unavailable in IUCLID, the most common causes are: Legal Entity not created, Working Context not set to "UK REACH", or Section 1.1 incomplete. See the IUCLID Inquiry Dossier Guide in the project folder for troubleshooting.

Step 3 — Confirm Submission

After submitting:

- You will receive an email acknowledgement from HSE/Defra to the address on your Defra account
- The portal will show the submission status
- Processing takes up to 10–15 working days (approximately 2 calendar weeks)

After Submission — What to Expect

When HSE completes processing your inquiry:

You will receive:

- An **inquiry number** (used in all future correspondence with HSE about this substance)
- Confirmation that the substance is already registered (UK-01-9638319484-0-0004)
- The **identity of the Lead Registrant** visible in your portal account
- Confirmation that your contact details have been shared with the existing registrant group

What happens next (automatically):

- The existing registrant(s) can see that Portland Fuel has submitted an inquiry for this substance
- They may contact you directly to discuss data sharing terms

Next Steps (Step 2 of Action Plan)

Once you have the Lead Registrant's identity from the portal:

1. **Contact the Lead Registrant** — introduce Portland Fuel, confirm your intended tonnage band (10–100 t/year) and intended import timeline
2. **Request consortium membership information** — ask about:
 - Consortium membership fee (typically £2,000–£5,000 for this tonnage band)
 - Letter of Access (LoA) cost and terms
 - Data sharing requirements
3. **Negotiate a Letter of Access** — this grants Portland Fuel the right to reference the existing registration data in its own submission

4. **Submit the joint registration** via IUCLID 6 and the Comply with UK REACH portal (this step will likely require a consultant)

Supplier angle (from Action Plan): The inquiry response may reveal which companies are registered to import/manufacture HVO in the UK. If Portland Fuel exclusively sources HVO from a UK-registered supplier, that supplier's registration covers the substance and Portland Fuel may not need to register at all. Confirm this point with the Lead Registrant or with HSE when the inquiry response arrives.

Key Contacts and Links

Resource	Details
Comply with UK REACH portal	comply-chemical-regulations.service.gov.uk
HSE UK REACH guidance hub	hse.gov.uk/reach
HSE new registrant guidance	hse.gov.uk/reach/new-registration.htm
GOV.UK compliance portal guidance	gov.uk — How to comply with REACH
IUCLID 6 Cloud	iuclid6.echa.europa.eu/iuclid6-cloud
HSE IT Support	ukreachitsupport@defra.gov.uk
IUCLID Dossier Guide	See <code>IUCLID_Inquiry_Dossier_Guide.md</code> in this project folder

Common Issues and Fixes

Problem	Cause	Fix
"Create Dossier" greyed out in IUCLID	Working Context not set	Top-right of IUCLID: set context to "UK REACH"
Legal Entity missing from dossier file	Advanced option not selected during export	Re-export dossier using advanced option, tick "include legal entity"
Portal rejects <code>.i6z</code> file	Wrong dossier type selected	Re-export from IUCLID selecting dossier type "Inquiry"
No email acknowledgement received	Wrong email on Defra account	Check portal account settings; contact ukreachitsupport@defra.gov.uk

Guide prepared using official HSE and [GOV.UK](https://gov.uk) sources. Verify all portal steps match the current live portal at time of submission — portal interfaces may be updated by HSE/Defra.